indentation? What is ...
outline?

TEXT 1

The teenage deserves all the sympathy in this world. In his jaundiced vision, the whole world has wronged him.

The very chicken and geese in the house are against him. When he approaches them, they scurry and scatter in disarray. Just because he is going to hurl a few rocks at them, these spoil-sports scamper away in dread of him. It really annoys him no end when he sees the same fowls flock around his younger brother and sister, and even eat corn out of their insignificant hands. Silly fowls!

The dog, Fido, which he, Akora, had brought in as a puppy four years ago, and fed with the leftovers from his plate, barks furiously at him when he swaggers into the yard attired in his tattered blue jeans, his patched anorak, and other fashionable castaway items of clothing that he has salvaged from the family archives. Especially when he tops this unearthly spectacle of himself by donning one of his friend's trendy hats, Fido barks and barks. Silly dog!

The cat, Mitty, annoys him even the more with its grudging silence. Just because he has not seen the inside of a bathroom for the past two weeks, the cat sniffs very noisily. Whenever he passes by, it opens only one eye to wink at him peevishly, and dozes off again, creating thereby an air of being thoroughly fed with the sight of him. Akora does not like that cat's sniffing much, but he dislikes its one-eyed wink even more. Surely, the beret should consider him worthy of a two-eyed open gaze? Silly cat!

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Then, there are the younger members of his family. Kojo is two full years younger than him. Yet, if he, Akora, orders him to sew the hole in the seat of his jeans, Kojo behaves as if he does not understand the language, they have been brought up speaking. Aba is even worse. When he commands her to bring him some food from the kitchen without telling their mother, she merely giggles and giggles. Silly boy and silly girl!

But worse of all was sheer life. Life has been treacherous to him. What all these unsightly spots on his face? What with only three strands of whiskers in the name of moustache? What with his body outgrowing his favourite pair of faded jeans? And horror of horrors, he is now getting dandruff. Silly life!

Poor teenager, it really is unfair that people around you should see you as worse than a pain in the neck. But never mind. You are so right, of course.

THE PLIGHTS OF A TEENAGER/ AKORA, THE POOR TEENAGER / A TEENAGER AND HIS WORLD

I. Things that Wrong Him

A. Domestic Animals

a. The chicken and geese

i. they scurry and scatter when he approaches them.

ii. the same fowls also eat corn out of his younger brother and sister's insignificant hands.

b. The dog

i. it barks furiously at him because he looks strange.

c. The cat

i. it sniffs very noisily at him because he smells.

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ii. it opens
him peevishly.

B. Younger Members of His Family

a. His brother (Kojo)
i. does not obey his orders.
ii. pretends he does not understand the language they were both brought up with.

b. His sister (Aba)
i. does not obey his commands.
ii. disrespects him.

c. Life
i. it has been treacherous to him.
ii. he has unsightly spots on his face.
iii. his moustache is made up of only three strands

Let us discuss the outline above. You can find that this outline also observes all the rules in writing an outline. You can identify a title. In this case, we have provided you with three titles. This is not to tell you that you can also use three titles for your outline. We are looking at titles that are suitable and so, you need to provide a title which looks most appropriate. Any one of the three titles can be used.

The title is not the only rule to observe as we saw in writing an outline, but labelling of divisions is equally an important rule to consider. In this particular text, you will find that information as presented in the text is categorized into major division, minor and sub-divisions. Information from the current text is not presented as was found in the previous text where we were able to get major divisions from the various topic sentences obtained from each paragraph. This text was not analyzed by considering the topic sentences in each body paragraph. It tells you that it is not at all times that we will find topic sentences clearly presented in text because writers have

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